

Jedi on Tauntauns

Table of Contents

- [Introduction](#)
- [Dice Mechanics](#)
 - [Standard Checks](#)
 - [Collaborative Checks](#)
 - [Contested Checks](#)
 - [Twist of Destiny](#)
 - [Destiny Points](#)
 - [Planned Actions](#)
 - [Bonuses and Penalties](#)
- [Characters](#)
 - [Stats](#)
 - [Force Sensitivity](#)
 - [Athleticism](#)
 - [Brains](#)
 - [Charm](#)
 - [Technician](#)
 - [Fight](#)
 - [Grit](#)
 - [Perception-style Checks](#)
 - [Feats](#)
 - [Injury Levels](#)
 - [Harm](#)
 - [Healing](#)
 - [Character Creation](#)
 - [Improvement Phases](#)
- [Gear](#)
- [Vehicles](#)
 - [Specs](#)
 - [Speed](#)
 - [Maneuverability](#)
 - [Firepower](#)
 - [Durability](#)
 - [Systems](#)
 - [Systems](#)
 - [Vehicles and Damage](#)
 - [Damage Between Vehicles and Characters](#)
 - [Vehicle Creation](#)
 - [Vehicle Improvement](#)
- [Examples](#)
 - [Example Character Build](#)

Introduction

This is a rules-lite hack of [Kids on Bikes](#) for use in a Star Wars setting. The intention of this system is to create a simple framework for telling shared, improvised stories with your friends. It is not intended as a simulationist engine for highly tactical gameplay. The emphasis should always be on having fun, moving the story forward, and player agency in service of the story.

Dice Mechanics

Jedi on Tauntauns uses all the standard polyhedral dice, except the d100. In all situations where you roll dice, rolling the maximum value of the die allows you to roll the die again, adding the second result cumulatively (i.e. dice explode). Dice may explode infinitely. The result of the roll is compared to either a target number or the result of a competitor's roll.

In general, the degree of success on a check should determine the scale of the outcome. If you succeed by a wide margin, you will have much more success than if you only just barely succeeded on the check. Similarly, just barely failing a check is not as bad as failing by a wide margin. The impact of a success or failure on a check should also take into account the scale of the action. Failing to chat up the barman will have much less impact than failing to convince the guards that you do actually belong in this high-security facility, even for the same degree of failure.

Standard Checks

A standard check is any check not covered by a more specific set of rules. When you make a standard check, the GM sets a target number for the check. You then roll your die for the Stat called for by the GM. If the result of your roll meets or exceeds the target number, you succeed on the check. Exceeding the target number by five or more may have extra benefits. Similarly, failing a check by five or more may have additional penalties.

Collaborative Checks

If multiple characters are working together to accomplish an action that is not a Planned Action (see below) each additional character may either attempt the check themselves or add +2 to the current attempt.

Contested Checks

A contested check is called for when two or more characters in a scene are competing over the outcome of an action. To resolve a contested check, each character makes a roll with the Stat they are using for the check (as determined by the GM). The highest result is the victor. Tied results represent a stalemate, and do not count as failures. As with standard checks, winning or losing by a margin of five or more may have additional benefits or penalties respectively.

Twist of Destiny

Anytime a character rolls a 1 on a die, they automatically fail the check as the will of the Force turns against them and some outside influence causes their attempt to go awry. This outside force could be anything from a stormtrooper showing up at an inopportune moment to deflector shields coming back online just before their attacks land, or anything else. The intention is that this is an outside force preventing their success, not a failure on their part to succeed.

Destiny Points

Whenever a character fails a check of any kind they receive a Destiny Point. By default Destiny Points can be used in the following ways:

- Add +1 to any roll of yours
- Add +1 to a Planned Action of another character

Any number of Destiny Points can be spent on a single roll. The bonus for Destiny Points is applied as specified in the Bonuses and Penalties section below. Feats may add additional uses for Destiny Points.

A character may have no more than 5 Destiny Points at any time. If Destiny Points would be gained past 5, they are instead lost immediately.

Destiny Points do not carry over between sessions.

Planned Actions

If a character is under no time pressure or stress when they make a check, they may make that check as a Planned Action. When making a Planned Action an actor may:

- Take half of the maximum die value for the Stat being used, instead of rolling the die (i.e. d10 -> 5, d12 -> 6, etc.)
- Receive help from other players, who spend their Destiny Points to grant +1 to the roll

Bonuses and Penalties

Spending Destiny Points and some Feats will provide bonuses or penalties to your checks. Both bonuses and penalties are applied after the roll is complete and before you evaluate success or failure. This means that they cannot make a die explode or prevent a die from exploding.

Characters

Characters in *Jedi on Tauntauns* are very simple mechanically. It is up to the player to add additional depth and nuance to any character beyond what is provided by the mechanics. As the Stats discussed below are broadly defined, it is up to the player to decide in what ways it is reasonable for their character to employ those statistics.

Mechanically, each player is composed of seven Stats and any number of Feats. Each Stat (except maybe Force Sensitivity) will have a dice type assigned to it as part of character creation. Additionally, Feats are available any time changes are made to a character, but are never required.

Stats

There are seven stats, listed with explanations below, that govern all of the checks that you might make as a character in *Jedi on Tauntauns*. Each stat is defined by its die size (i.e. d4, d6, d8, d10, d12, d20), though the Force Sensitivity Stat is potentially 0. All other stats default to d4 and are improved during character creation and any Improvement Phases. Stats are listed below with descriptions of the types of activities they cover.

Force Sensitivity

This Stat is unique in that it defaults to 0, meaning that it cannot be used in a check. Once this Stat has a die size assigned, you will use this Stat for any checks that involve the use of the Force, whether that's in manipulating objects, persuading people, or sensing presences.

Athleticism

This Stat determines the physical conditioning (i.e. how strong and fast) a character is. This Stat covers any check that involves physical activity and does not involve combat. This Stat also covers sneaking and slight of hand style checks.

Brains

This Stat determines how book-smart a character is. This Stat covers any check to recall knowledge, solve intellectual problems. Brains checks may also be used for medicine-related checks.

Charm

This Stat determines how socially adept a character is. This Stat covers any check to read other characters, lie, cheat, persuade, or interact with sentient and non-sentient creatures.

Technician

This Stat determines how well your character is able to work with technology and handle vehicles, regardless of scale or type. This Stat covers any check to manipulate/modify/repair technology, pilot a vehicle, or modify/repair vehicles.

Fight

This Stat determines how competent in combat scenarios a character is. This Stat covers any check related to aggressive action in combat. This Stat may also be used in place of Charm in some social situations when physical intimidation is used.

Grit

This Stat determines how durable your character is. This Stat covers any check to resist an aggressive action in combat, as well as to resist environmental or psychological hazards. This stat may also be used for checks that rely on how "street-smart" a character is, whether that is navigating a slum, haggling over prices, or surviving in a sandstorm.

Perception-style Checks

You may notice that there is no skill that covers the types of actions typically covered by perception or insight-style checks in other systems. Instead of having a dedicated skill for those actions, players can expect to make checks using the skills relevant to the situation or type of information they are seeking. Some examples are provided below:

Jim wants to see if the door he is about to enter is trapped. The GM will ask Jim for a Technician roll, because any trap would rely on technology.

Jim wants to track his quarry across a marsh. The GM will ask Jim for a Grit roll, as navigating in the natural environment is covered by Grit.

Jim wants to know if the smuggler is lying to him. The GM will ask Jim for an opposed Charm check against the smuggler, as this is a social situation.

The intention with having perception and insight-style checks handled in this manner is that it allows players to lean into their strengths, rather than being dependent on one skill for all of these different scenarios.

Feats

Feats are additional abilities you can unlock that provide bonuses, create new actions, or otherwise manipulate the rules for your character. Some example Feats are listed below. If you have an idea for a Feat that is not listed, present it to you GM for approval.

Feat	Cost	Description
Weapon Master	2 IP	Pick a type of weapon. When you make a Fight check with that type of weapon, you get a +2 bonus to that check.
Big Backpack	2 IP	You have a big backpack filled with useful objects. You may spend 1 Destiny Point to retrieve common object that could have fit in the backpack without having previously stated you acquired it. Because your backpack is so filled with random items, you take a -1 penalty to any Athleticism checks you make.
Snitch	1 IP	Spend a Destiny Point to locate and receive help (within reason) from law enforcement in any settlement with a problem involving a crime.
Underworld Connections	1 IP	Spend a Destiny Point to get an introduction to an underworld figure.
My Hunk of Junk	1 IP	Pick a specific vehicle. When you make a Technician check for that vehicle, you get a +2 bonus to that check.
Excellent Assistant	1 IP	When you spend Destiny Points on an ally's Planned Action, each Destiny Point you spend provides a +2 bonus.
Fated	3 IP	When you fail a check you receive two Destiny Points instead of one.
Nerves of Steel	1 IP	When you make a check that is not a Planned Action, you may spend 1 Destiny Point to take half of your die's value instead of rolling.
Infamous	1 IP	When you make a Charm check against underworld targets, you get a +2 bonus to that check. When you make a Charm check against a figure of authority, you take a -2 penalty to that check.
Guardian	2 IP	When a nearby ally would take an Injury Level, you may spend two Destiny Points to receive that Injury level instead.
Tough	2 IP	You can sustain two Minor Injuries before receiving a Major Injury.
Will of the Force	3 IP	Once per session you may choose to spend your Destiny Points during your roll, instead of after the roll. This means that you may spend Destiny Points to cause a die to explode.

Injury Levels

All player characters have five Injury Levels by default. These levels are as follows:

1. Uninjured
2. Minor Injury
3. Major Injury
4. Unconscious
5. Dead

When a character has a Major Injury, they receive a -2 penalty to all checks. An Unconscious character automatically fails all checks except Grit checks, to which they receive a -4 penalty.

Harm

Generally, aggressive actions are resolved with a Contested Check with the aggressor rolling Fight and the Defender rolling Grit. If the aggressor succeeds, their attack inflicts one Injury Level.

Healing

When a character has an Injury Level, they can generally heal that Injury Level by benefitting from a successful Brains check. Additionally, they could recover once a sufficient amount of time has passed.

Character Creation

When creating a new character, you will build your character out of a pool of 14 Improvement Points (IP). The mechanical character should be created following these steps:

1. Pick a race. Work with your GM to decide a Stat that should be bumped to d6 and a Feat specific to your race that you gain.
2. Distribute your 14 IP by spending them in any of the following ways:
 1. Spend 1 IP to increase a Stat by 1 die size, up to d12
 2. Spend 2 IP to increase a Stat from d12 to d20
 3. Spend IP equal to its cost to gain a Feat of your choice

Improvement Phases

Whenever you enter an Improvement Phase, you are granted 2 additional IP. You may then spend any IP you have (including leftover IP from character creation or previous Improvement phases), as defined in the Character Creation section above.

Gear

Gear is exclusively narrative. This means that while you may need a specific piece of gear to be allowed to perform some actions, gear does not provide any Stat or other bonuses beyond that.

Please note that these rules intentionally do not provide a system for tracking currency. It is up to you and your GM to decide what role, if any, currency plays in your story.

Vehicles

Vehicles are similar, but not the same to characters. Every vehicle will have a set of five Specs. Each of these Specs covers a range of activities you might perform while using the vehicle. Each Spec is a bonus or penalty that is applied to your character's roll whenever you make a Stat check to perform a related activity. Additionally, each vehicle can have a number of systems that expand its capabilities.

Specs

Specs define the performance characteristics of a vehicle. All Specs start at a value of -1.

Speed

Speed covers activities related to the speed of the vehicle, typically outrunning other vehicles or traveling between places. Checks related to the Speed Spec are typically performed with a Technician Stat check.

Maneuverability

Maneuverability covers activities related to maneuvering the vehicle, like navigating through tricky spots or escaping from pursuing craft. Checks related to the Maneuverability Spec are typically performed with a Technician Stat check.

Firepower

Firepower covers aggressive activities performed with your vehicle. This includes everything from firing you turbolasers to ramming an opposing vehicle. Checks related to the Firepower Spec are typically performed with a Fight Stat check.

Durability

Durability covers how well your vehicle stands up to the wear and tear of use. This means everything from taking a turbolaser impact to getting in a fender bender. Checks related to the Durability Spec are typically performed with a Technician check.

Systems

Systems covers activities that are related to the use of specific systems in place on your vehicle that are not covered by another Spec. This means everything from the sensors to the medical bay to the cloaking device to the astronav. Checks related to the Systems Spec are typically performed with a Brains check.

Systems

Every vehicle can have some number of systems that provide additional capabilities. Examples of these are listed below, but you should always feel free to work with your GM to design additional new systems. Some systems my directly increase or decrease the bonuses and penalties your vehicle's Specs provide, while other systems may simply provide new capabilities. You can think of Systems like Feats.

System	Cost	Description
Improved Manuevering Jets	1VP	Increase this vehicle's Maneuverability Spec by 1.
Greater Improved Manuevering Jets	2VP	Increase this vehicle's Maneuverability Spec by 1.
Concealed Compartments	1VP	This vehicle now has hidden cargo containers

System	Cost	Description
Distinctive Livery	1VP	This vehicle is painted in a distinctive livery. If this livery is associated with a particular organization, you receive a +2 bonus to Charm checks related to that organization while in or near the vehicle. This vehicle receives a -2 penalty to checks while trying to pretend to be a different vehicle.
A Hydrospanner a Day...	1VP	One or more characters may spend a full day wrenching on this vehicle. For one week or until this vehicle is next damaged (whichever comes first), this vehicle receives a +1 bonus to all Specs.
Reinforced Hull	2VP	This vehicle can sustain two instances of Minor Damage before receiving Major Damage.

Vehicles and Damage

Like characters, vehicles have 5 Damage Levels by default:

1. Undamaged
2. Minor Damage
3. Major Damage
4. Disabled
5. Destroyed

When a vehicle has Major Damage, it receive a -2 penalty to all Specs. A Disabled vehicle automatically fails all checks except Durability checks, to which it receives a -4 penalty.

Damage Between Vehicles and Characters

Due to the difference in scale, Damage and Injury are not directly exchangeable. Most attacks by characters against vehicles will not cause Damage to vehicles, since they are so much larger. Conversely, most attacks by vehicles are likely to be fatal for characters, as vehicle weapons are much more powerful.

Vehicle Creation

Creating vehicles is very similar to creating characters. Vehicles are created out of a pool of 10 Vehicle Points (VP). To create the mechanical profile of the vehicle, follow the following steps:

1. Pick a vehicle. Work with your GM to determine one Spec to increase to +1 and one System to add to the vehicle.
2. Distribute your 14 IP by spending them in any of the following ways:
 1. Spend 1VP to increase a Spec by 1 up to a maximum of +3.
 2. Spend VP equal to its cost to gain a System of your choice

Vehicle Improvement

Whenever you get a Vehicle Improvement (as decided with your GM) you are granted 2 additional VP. You may then spend any VP you have (including leftover IP from vehicle creation or previous Vehicle Improvements), as defined in the Vehicle Creation section above.

Examples

Example Character Build

Jim decides he wants to play a Wookiee enforcer for a small-time crime boss named Nyysh. Since he has decided on playing a Wookiee, he starts by working with his GM to determine which Stat should start at d6. Together, they decide that Athleticism will start at d6 to reflect the natural strength of Wookies.

Next, Jim and his GM come up with a starting Feat for Wookies. They decide to make a new Feat:

Feat	Cost	Description
Fearsome Strength	N/A	When you make an Athleticism check based on strength, each Destiny Point you spend increases your result by 2 instead of 1.

Now that Jim and his GM have decided on the Stat boost and Feat from being a Wookiee, it is up to Jim to decide how to spend his 14 IP to complete building Nyysh.

Since Jim wants Nyysh to be a very competent fighter he spends 6 of those points to increase his Fight Stat to a d20. This requires him to spend 4 points to reach d12 (d4 -> d6, d6 -> d8, d8 -> d10, and d10 -> d12) and 2 points to reach d20 (d12 -> d20).

Then, Jim spends 2 points on Nyysh's Grit to bring it up to d8, 1 point on Athleticism to bring it up to d8. He puts 1 point into Charm to bring it up to d6. Then he puts 2 points into Technician, since he wants to represent Nyysh's driving skills, which brings Nyysh's Technician Stat up to d8.

With his last 2 points, Jim decides to take two Feats. The first, Underworld Connections, is described above, and represents the connections Nyysh has formed while working in the underworld. The second Feat is another that Jim makes up and gets approved by his GM, Aggressive Demeanor.

Feat	Cost	Description
Aggressive Demeanor	1 IP	When you use Athleticism to try to intimidate a target, you receive a +2 bonus to that check. If you fail that check, the target is much more likely to react with violence.

This completes the mechanical character creation process for Jim's character. In the end, he will have a character with the following profile:

Force Sensitivity	Athleticism	Brains	Charm	Fight	Grit	Technician
0	d8	d4	d6	d20	d8	d8

Feat	Cost	Description
Fearsome Strength	N/A	When you make an Athleticism check based on strength, each Destiny Point you spend increases your result by 2 instead of 1.
Aggressive Demeanor	1 IP	When you use Athleticism to try to intimidate a target, you receive a +2 bonus to that check. If you fail that check, the target is much more likely to react with violence.

Feat	Cost	Description
Underworld Connections	1 IP	Spend a Destiny Point to get an introduction to an underworld figure.